

# Pocketing and Driving

This session is about turning walls into pockets and driving out. Secondary focus on brace tracking.

## Overview

### Off Skates Warm-up 5-10 Minutes Before the Session

Lightly making sure that the joints still work.

Focus is **not** on building strength, cardio or endurance, just on limbering up. Do 5 to 10 reps of each, on each side.

- Toe taps + one leg light squats
- Arm, shoulder and neck stretches
- Opening and closing hip rotations
- Knee raise to superman
- Cross chest knee raises
- Butt kicks, high knees, side shuffles

### Basic Warm-up - 15 minutes

Mostly standard edge-work warm-up. Stage in faster laps rather than doing them all at once. Do forwards and backwards.

- Sticky skating - Regular, Figure 8, low
- Regular weaves + carves
- One foot line-to-line (it not able, then serpentine).
- One foot lateral
- Fast laps
- Stops

### One Foot Blocking - 10 minutes

Warming up edges with some contact. One skater driving, the other skater blocking on one foot. This will be a useful technique for resisting the driving drills to come.

## Drives - 30 Minutes

This next session is a revision on different driving drills. Each drill should be run twice, once to feel out the movement, and the second time with a small modification.

- Hip drive starting engaged
- Hip drive from one to two feet
- Shoulder drive
- Low shoulder drive- with a focus on shoulder to butt cheek driving where possible.
- Shoulder drive into Chest drive
- Shelf drive starting engaged.

Blockers should attempt to resist, especially using the one foot blocking from earlier. Blockers should act as if they were a butt in a wall - hence they cannot simply avoid the hit without displacing themselves

The offence should be seeking to move the blocker at least one lane, but ideally to take them off the track.

## 360 Offence - 10 minutes

Mixing up the drives now, start with an offence engaged in a three wall.

- Run the 360 offence drill - 30 seconds to 1 minute per offence, then a rest.
- Move onto skewering practice.

This is a higher intensity drill, so cycling skaters for a rest is a good idea.

## Two Wall Pocket and Drive - 15 minutes

Jammer starts behind a colinear two wall. Butt is a filter, brace is a catch, butt then pockets. Brace catch can be a chest, a back or a sandbag. Example figure here.

## Pocket and Drive - 30 minutes

In three or two walls. Jammer starts a foot behind, engaged blocker holds with back, disengaged blocker drives to a line for a pocket and hit out.

Optional cutting a friend. Jammers are not allowed to be comfortable.

## Four Walls - Remainder of the time

Either a four wall pocketing drill or a four wall resetting drill depending on the vibe. See notes for the drill details.

## Drill Notes

### Serpentine

As different extension to one footed weaves.

Rather than two lanes of the track at a sharper angle than 45 degrees glide from line to line on one foot. At the line, or as close to it as the skater feels comfortable use the edges of the skate to turn, as in a weave or a carve to face the other line and continue the motion.

As we're not currently generating momentum from this motion after two or three turns change feet. The focus is on the sharpness of the turn, rather than the speed. Speed may be added after technique has been polished.

Progression of this drill is in sharpening angles, maintaining momentum and incorporating self-propelled motions.

### Skating to Toe Stops and Back

This section deals with alternating between skating, running on toe-stops and moving back to skating.

The primary difficulty with this skill is that toe-stops are typically angled such that jumping onto them while rolling without first matching momentum will result in the skater falling over. This angling also means that this skill is easier to practice backwards.

All of the following drills should be attempted at low speed first. If the skater is not comfortable moving at the required speed when starting on toe stops, they should not attempt to move onto toe stops from that speed when rolling.

#### Skating Backwards

Skate backwards, hop onto toe stops for a couple of steps, resume skating backwards. This is easier than the forwards version as the toe stops are already angled backwards.

If the skater needs to bail out from this movement they can drop onto their toe stops and come to a stop.

#### Sideways

Similarly to the backwards version, this can also be performed sideways while avoiding angling issues with toe-stops.

From a side surf, incorporate a small jump landing on toe stops. The skater then uses their existing momentum to perform a side shuffle or a grapevine on toe stops. They then return to a side surf.

If the skater is concerned by the sideways momentum on their toe-stops, the first toe-stop steps may be accompanied by a partial transition for greater stability.

#### Skating Forwards

The hardest of the three. Care must be taken to place the toe-stops at the correct angle while moving forwards. Leaning forwards will help with this, as will maintaining momentum.

### Drill: 360 Offence

This drill requires four skaters, three blockers and an opposing offence.

The original drill uses two to three different drives, I'll be updating this to four.

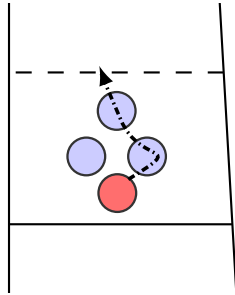
- Hip drive using lateral pushes
- Shoulder to hip drive
- Chest drive
- Shelf drive using lateral pushes

The goal is to chain these drives together to dismember a wall.

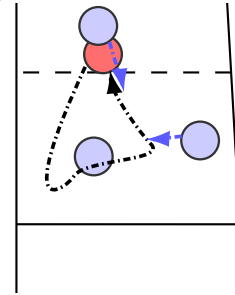
The offence starts in the centre of the wall, where the jammer would normally be.

The offence should then attempt to drive one of the butts, switch and drive the brace then disengage and reset to drive the other butt towards the centre of the track before switching to again driving the brace. Then reset in the centre and repeat in the opposite direction.

Meanwhile the wall should seek to reform and counter the incoming offence.



*Offence from within the seam, pushing out then taking the brace.*

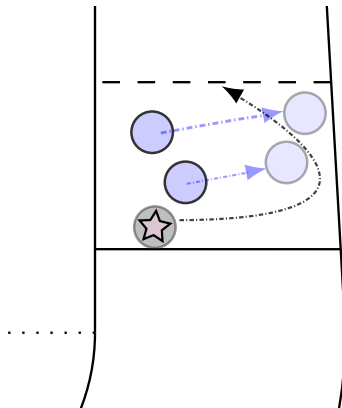


*Offence starting from the line, optionally skewering, then taking the brace.*

#### *Progressions*

As an offence progression - drive both butts together off the track as part of the final movement as in the skewering drill.

### **Drill: Double Lines**



*The approximate path of the jammer and blockers.*

This drill involves a colinear two wall and a jammer. There are four variations of this drill.

In rough order of difficulty these are:

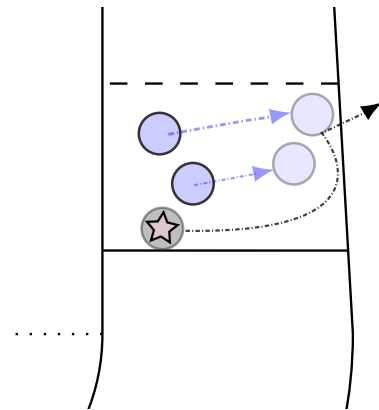
- Blocker in lane 1.5, brace in lane 1
- Blocker in lane 3.5, brace in lane 4
- Blocker in lane 1.5, brace in lane 2
- Blocker in lane 3.5, brace in lane 3

The jammer begins behind the rear blocker.

The goal of the jammer is to out-pace the wall to the other side of the track and pass the blockers in either lane 1 or lane 4. The jammer must commit to this movement until they have passed the first blocker.

The goals of this drill vary depending on the level of the jammer and the blockers.

- The first goal is for the jammer to outpace the blockers sufficiently to escape.
- The second is for the blockers to reach the line in time to prevent this. This will often involve the first blocker arriving too late, while the brace is in position to catch the jammer.
- The third goal is for the jammer to avoid taking a double line and instead cut back into the seam.
- Lastly, the blockers, after cutting off the line should close shoulders to prevent the jammer cutting through.



*The jammer fails to cut back in and is caught or hit out.*

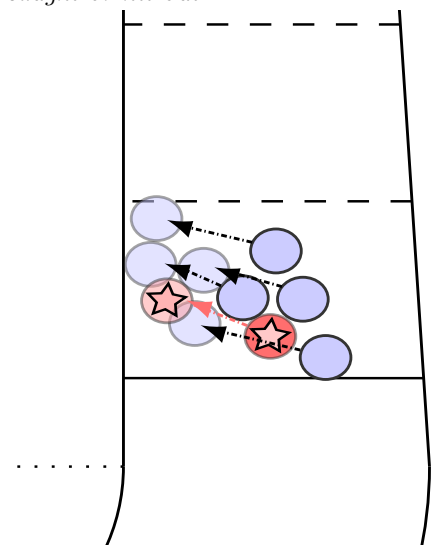
### Four Wall Pocket

This drill requires five skaters - four blockers, and a jammer.

Starting in lane two or three, the jammer should be engaged with the wall. The fourth blocker should then approach the jammer from slightly behind and to the side, and using their chest drive the jammer out. The wall may rotate slightly to assist this, but the brace should remain on the line.

The rest of the wall needs to remain rigid and strong - if the butts turn then the jammer will have purchase.

The fourth blocker, while pushing, should establish a position where their rear leg is behind the jammer, cutting off that direction, while using their shoulders to rotate the jammer's shoulders out of the wall to face them. From this position the jammer has no legal movements as the blocker's backs are in the way, and the last blocker is preventing cutting back in. If the jammer holds position then they will be assessed a stop block, as a result the only legal action is to be knocked out of play.



*Jammer is trapped both down and up-track.*

### Four Wall Reset

This drill requires six skaters - four blockers, a jammer and an offence.

Three blockers set up as a three wall, the fourth blocker should set up as an additional brace supporting both the three wall brace and one of the other blockers (typically the inside blocker).

The jammer should start engaged for this drill, while the offence is free to start either down or up track.

The goal of this drill is for the fourth blocker to reform into the wall whenever the offence picks off a skater. The picked off blocker should then reform as the secondary brace. As some examples:

- If the offence takes the brace, then the fourth blocker should take the brace position.
- If the offence takes the blocker on the same side as the fourth blocker, then the blocker can sandbag, and slot back into that position.
- Alternatively, if the opposite blocker is taken, then the brace can sandbag into that position, and the fourth blocker can replace the brace.